A Car on the Moon?!

Your boots crunch against the grey lunar dust.

Ahead, giant craters scar the ground. Strange rocks lie scattered everywhere, and distant mountains rise beneath a pitch-black sky.

You're on the Moon! There's so much to explore, but walking in a bulky spacesuit is hard work.

Wouldn't a car make things easier?

Well, NASA had the same idea!

In 1971, astronauts took something extraordinary to the Moon: a little electric car!

Meet the Moon Buggy!

Four wheels. Two seats. One dusty world to explore.

Meet the Lunar Roving Vehicle, better known as the Moon buggy!

It arrived with the Apollo 15 astronauts, ready to take them farther across the lunar surface than their boots could carry them.

For the first time, astronauts could drive on the Moon!

Folded Up for Space!

Here's the clever part: the Moon buggy didn't arrive looking like a car.

It was folded and packed inside the lunar module, like a giant piece of space furniture!

Once on the Moon, astronauts pulled special cords and unfolded its wheels, seats and other parts.

A few careful steps later, it was ready to roll!

No Petrol Needed!

Where's the petrol tank?

There isn't one!

The Moon buggy ran on electricity, powered by batteries.

Petrol engines need oxygen to burn fuel, but the Moon has almost no atmosphere.

Even better, each wheel had its own electric motor.

Four wheels, four motors, and absolutely no petrol stations!

Wheels from Another World

Take a closer look. Those aren't ordinary car tyres!

The Moon buggy's wheels were made from special metal mesh, with metal strips to help grip the dusty ground.

They were designed to handle rocks, bumps and loose lunar soil.

No rubber tyres. No air pumps. Just clever engineering built for the Moon!

No GPS. So How Did It Navigate?

The astronauts are driving across a world with no road signs and no GPS.

So how do they know where they're going?

The rover had special navigation equipment that measured how far it travelled and used a gyroscope to track its direction.

It was like having a compass and step counter built into the car!

Hello, Earth!

The Moon buggy wasn't just carrying astronauts. It was carrying a camera, too!

A television camera sent pictures back to Earth, allowing people to watch the lunar adventure.

And here's the cool part: people at Mission Control could remotely move the camera to follow the astronauts!

It was a tiny TV studio on four wheels!

The Car That Never Came Home

The astronauts packed up and headed home, but the Moon buggy stayed behind.

NASA sent three of these rovers to the Moon: with Apollo 15, 16 and 17.

Today, all three remain on the lunar surface, silent and still.

Their batteries are no longer usable, and their wheels haven't turned since the Apollo missions.

But they helped astronauts explore farther and collect valuable samples that scientists still study.

They may have been left behind, but their discoveries live on.

Your Turn!

You're sitting in the Moon buggy. The dusty lunar landscape stretches ahead.

A giant crater is waiting in the distance.

Do you drive towards it, explore the nearby mountains, or search for something nobody has discovered?

Where would your first Moon adventure take you?